

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Lamplighter's Wife is a 1908 novel by Cordelia Ashgrove. Over the course of the novel, the character Ines is portrayed as gradually losing the deference she once showed toward her employer: _____

Which quotation from The Lamplighter's Wife most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Ines had always spoken softly in Mrs. Peverell's presence, keeping her eyes fixed on the floorboards and her hands folded before her."

B: "In her first year Ines had answered every summons with a curtsy and a murmured 'as you wish'; by the third she answered from the doorway without turning, and by the fifth she did not always answer at all."

C: "Ines disliked Mrs. Peverell's habit of rearranging the pantry, though she never said so aloud to anyone in the household."

D: "Mrs. Peverell had grown more demanding with age, issuing instructions twice over as though the first had gone unheard."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The claim is about GRADUAL CHANGE. B tracks Ines across five years, showing deference steadily eroding. A shows only the early deferential state -- no change. C shows private dislike, not a shift in outward behavior. D describes Mrs. Peverell changing, not Ines. TRICK: When a claim says 'gradually' or 'over the course of,' the quotation must show at least two points in time.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Sculptor Ilaria Bonetti has argued that the rough, unpolished surfaces she leaves on her bronze figures invite viewers to touch the work rather than simply observe it from a distance.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Bonetti's argument?

A: Visitors surveyed at a gallery said they found Bonetti's rough-surfaced figures more emotionally striking than polished bronzes displayed nearby.

B: Bonetti spends roughly twice as long preparing the surface texture of a figure as she does on the casting itself.

C: Art critics writing about Bonetti's work have frequently described her surfaces using tactile vocabulary such as 'gritty' and 'weathered.'

D: Gallery attendants recorded that visitors reached out to touch Bonetti's rough-surfaced figures roughly five times as often as they touched the polished bronzes displayed in the same room.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Bonetti's claim is about VIEWER BEHAVIOR -- touching. D measures actual touching with a comparison. A measures emotional response, not touching. B describes her process, not viewer response. C shows critics use tactile WORDS, which is language, not behavior. TRICK: If the claim predicts an action, the evidence must record that action, not feelings or descriptions of it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Ornithologist Desmond Achterberg has claimed that the alpine finch caches seeds in autumn specifically to survive winter food shortages, rather than caching them opportunistically whenever seeds are abundant.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Achterberg's claim?

A: Alpine finches increased their caching rate sharply in autumn even in years when seed abundance was low, and retrieved the majority of cached seeds during the coldest weeks of winter.

B: Alpine finches have been observed caching seeds in every month except midwinter.

C: Alpine finches were not observed caching seeds during an unusually mild winter.

D: Seed abundance in the alpine finch's range peaks in early autumn, shortly before caching behavior begins.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Achterberg's claim distinguishes PURPOSEFUL winter provisioning from OPPORTUNISTIC caching. A shows caching happening even when seeds are scarce (so not opportunistic) and retrieval timed to winter (so purposeful). D actually fits the opportunistic explanation. B and C describe when caching is absent, which does not establish purpose. TRICK: For 'X rather than Y' claims, find evidence that fits X and does NOT fit Y.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Saltmarsh Road is a 1994 novel by Winifred Osei-Tutu. The narrator presents the character Gideon as someone who repeatedly promises to change his habits but takes no steps toward doing so: _____

Which quotation from Saltmarsh Road most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Gideon announced at supper that he intended to give up the late nights and the card table for good, and his sister said nothing at all."

B: "Gideon had not touched a deck of cards in six weeks, though he still kept one in his coat pocket for reasons he could not explain."

C: "Every January Gideon swore off the card table, and every January he renewed his membership at the club, explaining that the dues were already paid and it would be wasteful not to use them."

D: "Gideon's mother had long since stopped believing his promises, and she no longer bothered to remind him of them."

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The claim needs BOTH the promise AND the failure to act. C shows the yearly vow paired with the immediate contradictory action. A shows only the promise. B shows actual change, contradicting the claim. D shows his mother's reaction, not Gideon's behavior. TRICK: 'Promises but takes no steps' requires the quote to contain both halves -- a stated intention and evidence it wasn't followed.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Materials researcher Jae-Won Suh has argued that adding recycled glass powder to concrete increases its resistance to cracking under repeated freezing and thawing.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Suh's argument?

A: Concrete containing recycled glass powder cost less to produce than conventional concrete of the same volume.

B: Conventional concrete without glass powder developed visible cracks after 40 freeze-thaw cycles.

C: Concrete containing recycled glass powder had a smoother surface finish than conventional concrete.

D: After 100 freeze-thaw cycles, concrete samples containing recycled glass powder showed 60 percent less crack length per square meter than conventional concrete samples tested under identical conditions.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The claim is about CRACK RESISTANCE under freeze-thaw. D compares both formulations under identical conditions on exactly that measure. B gives data on conventional concrete alone with no comparison. A measures cost. C measures surface finish. TRICK: A single-group result proves nothing about a comparative claim -- you need both conditions measured.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The Ferryman's Ledger is a 1976 novel by Absalom Quaye. The narrator describes the character Nnenna as someone who conceals her generosity behind a manner of studied indifference: _____

Which quotation from The Ferryman's Ledger most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Nnenna shrugged when the widow's rent came due and said it was no concern of hers; the landlord was paid that Friday by a hand nobody could name, and Nnenna complained all week about the price of yams."

B: "Nnenna gave freely to anyone who asked and made certain the whole quarter knew the sum, for she believed generosity ought to be visible."

C: "Nnenna kept her accounts with a precision that unsettled the other traders, recording every cowrie that passed through her hands."

D: "Nnenna had little patience for the widow's troubles and said so plainly whenever the subject arose at market."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The claim requires generosity that is HIDDEN behind indifference. A shows the dismissive words, the anonymous payment, and the continued grumbling as cover. B shows generosity that is deliberately visible -- the opposite. C shows meticulousness, not generosity. D shows indifference with no hidden generosity. TRICK: When a claim says 'conceals X behind Y,' the quote must show X actually happening while Y is on display.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Historian Marguerite Delacroix-Bell has argued that eighteenth-century coffeehouses in London functioned as venues where people of different social ranks mixed and exchanged information on relatively equal terms.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Delacroix-Bell's argument?

A: A prominent London merchant recorded in his diary that he visited a coffeehouse near the Exchange almost every morning for thirty years.

B: Surviving subscription books from a dozen London coffeehouses list patrons ranging from titled gentlemen to apprentices and ship's clerks, and house rules posted in several establishments explicitly barred patrons from claiming precedence by rank.

C: London coffeehouses imported most of their coffee through a small number of licensed merchants operating out of the port.

D: Coffeehouses in eighteenth-century London outnumbered taverns in several central parishes.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The claim is about SOCIAL MIXING ON EQUAL TERMS across a whole institution. B shows both the range of ranks present and rules enforcing equality. A describes one merchant's habit, not mixing across ranks. C concerns supply chains. D counts establishments. TRICK: A claim about a group or institution needs evidence about the group, not a single individual's routine.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Hydrologist Solveig Ranasinghe has claimed that the recent expansion of a coastal wetland is the result of sediment deposited by an upstream dam removal rather than of rising local sea levels.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Ranasinghe's claim?

A: The coastal wetland has expanded by roughly 15 percent over the past decade.

B: Local sea levels have risen measurably over the same decade in which the wetland expanded.

C: Sediment cores from the expanded portion of the wetland are composed largely of material geologically matched to the riverbed above the removed dam, and the expansion began within two years of the removal.

D: Wetlands elsewhere along the same coastline have contracted over the past decade.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Ranasinghe attributes expansion to DAM SEDIMENT, not sea level. C matches the sediment to its upstream source and ties the timing to the removal. A states the effect without a cause. B supports the rival explanation. D is a contrast that leaves the cause unidentified. TRICK: To support a specific cause, look for evidence linking the effect to that source -- composition, timing, or a traceable signature.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: *Winter Assizes* is a 1961 novel by Hugh Ferrers-Kane. The narrator characterizes the judge Alderton as a man whose severity is legendary among strangers but invisible to those who know him well: _____

Which quotation from *Winter Assizes* most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Alderton had sentenced more men to hard labour than any judge on the circuit, and the newspapers had given him a nickname he pretended not to know."

B: "Barristers newly called to the bar approached Alderton's bench as though approaching a cliff edge; his own clerk of twenty years brought him tea unbidden and argued with him about the cricket scores."

C: "Alderton spoke to everyone in the same clipped register, whether addressing a defendant, a duchess, or the boy who swept the steps."

D: "Those who had known Alderton at school remembered him as an anxious child, easily moved to tears by the smallest unfairness."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The claim contrasts how STRANGERS see him with how INTIMATES see him. B shows both audiences at once: new barristers terrified, the longtime clerk casual. A shows only the fearsome reputation. C shows uniform treatment, which contradicts the contrast. D describes his childhood, a different time frame, not present-day intimates. TRICK: When a claim names two audiences, the quotation must show both reacting differently.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Economist Perrine Vasquez-Oyelaran has argued that small-scale informal lending networks in urban markets function less as sources of credit than as mechanisms for enforcing social reputation among traders.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Vasquez-Oyelaran's argument?

- A: Traders in the market borrow from informal networks at interest rates well below those charged by licensed lenders.
- B: The total volume of informal lending in the market exceeds the volume of formal bank lending to the same traders.
- C: Most informal loans in the market are repaid in full and on schedule.
- D: Traders who defaulted on informal loans were rarely pursued for repayment but were excluded from bulk-purchasing groups and denied suppliers' references, and most loans were extended to traders who could have obtained bank credit on similar terms.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The claim says the networks are ABOUT REPUTATION MORE THAN CREDIT. D shows both halves: default triggers social penalties rather than collection (reputation), and borrowers did not need the credit (so credit is not the point). A, B, and C all emphasize the networks' credit function -- the very thing the claim downplays. TRICK: 'Less X than Y' claims require evidence that diminishes X while establishing Y.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Cartwright Inheritance is a 1983 novel by Delphine Marchetti-Ruiz. The narrator portrays the character Bram as someone who applies the same rigid frugality to every part of his life, whether trivial or consequential: _____

Which quotation from The Cartwright Inheritance most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Bram reused the same envelope until the flap gave out, walked two miles to avoid a tram fare, and declined the surgery his physician recommended on the grounds that the sum could be better spent."

B: "Bram kept a ledger of household expenses in which no purchase, however small, went unrecorded."

C: "Bram had inherited a considerable estate and lived as though he had inherited nothing at all."

D: "Bram's frugality had been remarked upon by everyone in the parish, some with admiration and others with something closer to alarm."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The claim stresses frugality across BOTH trivial AND consequential matters. A gives trivial examples (envelope, tram fare) and a consequential one (declining surgery). B shows only small-scale bookkeeping. C states the trait without illustrating its range. D reports others' opinions. TRICK: When a claim says 'whether trivial or consequential,' the quotation needs examples at both ends of the scale.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Neuroscientist Thaddeus Owusu-Lindgren has proposed that the human brain processes written words in a dedicated region that responds to letter strings specifically, not merely to any complex visual pattern.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Owusu-Lindgren's proposal?

A: The proposed region shows elevated activity when participants view written words compared to when they view a blank screen.

B: The proposed region is more active in literate adults than in adults who have never learned to read.

C: The proposed region responded strongly to pronounceable letter strings but showed no elevated response to visually matched strings of unfamiliar symbols equated for complexity, contrast, and spatial frequency.

D: Damage to the proposed region is associated with difficulty recognizing faces as well as difficulty reading.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The claim's key word is SPECIFICALLY -- letters, not complex patterns generally. C uses a control that matches visual complexity but removes letterhood, isolating the specific response. A only compares to a blank screen, which any visual stimulus would beat. B supports involvement in reading but not letter-specificity. D suggests the region is NOT specific. TRICK: Specificity claims need a control that shares every property except the one at issue.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Harbour Lights is a 1955 novel by Constance Adebayo-Hall. The narrator depicts the character Otilie as someone who interprets every kindness shown to her as evidence of an obligation she must immediately repay: _____

Which quotation from Harbour Lights most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "I had never understood why Otilie found it so difficult to accept help, and I confess I sometimes resented the effort it took to offer it."

B: "When Mrs. Larkin left a basket of pears at the door, Otilie spent the evening calculating their worth and appeared at the Larkins' gate the next morning with a mended coat, a jar of preserves, and an apology for the delay."

C: "Otilie had grown up in a household where nothing was given without a condition attached, and the habit had outlasted the household by thirty years."

D: "Otilie thanked the neighbours warmly for the pears and said she would think of them every time she ate one."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The claim describes Otilie's PATTERN of converting kindness into debt. B shows her receiving a gift, valuing it, and over-repaying immediately. A gives the narrator's feelings. C explains the origin of the trait but does not show it in action. D shows ordinary gratitude, not compulsive repayment. TRICK: The quotation must show the character enacting the trait, not the narrator commenting on it or a backstory explaining it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Linguist Bartholomew Nakagawa-Cole has argued that speakers of a regional dialect preserve an older grammatical construction in casual speech but abandon it in situations they perceive as formal.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Nakagawa-Cole's argument?

A: Older speakers of the dialect use the construction more frequently than younger speakers do.

B: The construction appears in written records of the region dating to the seventeenth century.

C: Speakers of the dialect reported in interviews that they consider the construction to be old-fashioned.

D: The same speakers used the construction in 78 percent of eligible contexts when conversing with family members at home but in only 4 percent of eligible contexts when addressing an unfamiliar interviewer in a municipal office.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The claim is about the SAME speakers varying by SITUATION. D holds the speakers constant and varies the setting, showing the formality effect. A compares age groups, a different variable. B establishes the construction's age, not its situational use. C reports attitudes, not usage. TRICK: When a claim says the same people behave differently across contexts, the evidence must track one group across those contexts.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The Sound of Dry Grass is a 2007 novel by Marisol Etxeberria. The narrator characterizes the protagonist, Casimiro, as someone who mistakes his own stubbornness for principle: _____

Which quotation from The Sound of Dry Grass most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Casimiro refused the settlement a fourth time, telling the lawyer that a man who bends once will bend always -- though when pressed he could not say what principle the case turned on, only that he had said no and would not be the sort of man who says no and then yes."

B: "Casimiro lost the house, the orchard, and finally the goodwill of his brother, who had begged him to settle before the costs consumed what remained."

C: "Casimiro had been raised by a father who considered compromise the first symptom of cowardice, and he had never questioned the inheritance."

D: "Casimiro believed deeply in fairness and had once walked six miles to return a coin given to him in error."

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The claim requires stubbornness DISGUISED as principle. A shows the refusal, the high-minded justification, and the revealing gap when he cannot name the principle. B shows consequences of the trait. C gives its origin. D shows genuine principle, which contradicts the claim. TRICK: For 'mistakes X for Y' claims, the quote must expose the gap -- the character invoking Y while actually acting on X.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Archaeologist Yolanda Przybylski has proposed that a Bronze Age workshop site was used for producing goods intended for long-distance exchange rather than for local household consumption.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Przybylski's proposal?

A: The workshop contained hearths, storage pits, and food remains typical of a Bronze Age domestic compound.

B: Objects of the type produced at the workshop have been found at sites throughout the region, including within a few kilometers of the workshop itself.

C: The workshop produced a narrow range of highly standardized objects in quantities far exceeding what the surrounding settlement could have used, and finished examples of these objects have been recovered only at sites more than 300 kilometers distant.

D: Tools recovered from the workshop show wear patterns consistent with prolonged and skilled use.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The claim contrasts LONG-DISTANCE EXCHANGE with LOCAL USE. C establishes overproduction relative to local need and a distant distribution, ruling out local consumption. B undercuts the claim by placing finds nearby. A points toward domestic use. D shows skilled production without indicating destination. TRICK: For 'made for export, not local use' claims, look for volume beyond local need PLUS distant distribution.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Philosopher Anselm Rautavaara-Diaz has argued that some apparent disagreements are merely verbal: the parties assign different meanings to a shared term and would agree entirely if the ambiguity were resolved.

Which of the following scenarios, if true, would most clearly exemplify the phenomenon Rautavaara-Diaz describes?

A: Two economists disagree about whether a proposed policy will reduce unemployment, and each cites a different body of evidence in support of a different forecast.

B: Two biologists argue about whether a certain organism is 'rare,' and on examination one has been using the term to mean few individuals overall while the other has been using it to mean narrowly distributed; once each states which he means, neither disputes the other's factual description of the organism.

C: Two historians agree on all the relevant facts about an event but reach opposite conclusions about whether it was justified.

D: Two engineers disagree about which of two designs is superior, and after extensive testing one concedes that the other's design performs better.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: A merely verbal dispute dissolves once the ambiguity is named. B shows exactly that: two senses of 'rare,' and no residual disagreement afterward. A is a substantive empirical dispute. C is a genuine evaluative disagreement over shared facts. D is a factual dispute resolved by evidence, not by clarifying language. TRICK: The test for a verbal dispute is that clarifying the word ends the argument, with nothing left to disagree about.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Public health researcher Ngozi Vandermeulen has argued that a community's shift toward cycling for short trips has been driven primarily by people who previously made those trips by car, not by people who previously walked.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Vandermeulen's argument?

A: Among residents who took up cycling for short trips, 71 percent reported that they had previously made those trips by car and 6 percent that they had previously walked, and pedestrian counts in the district remained essentially unchanged.

B: The number of residents cycling for short trips tripled over the study period.

C: Car ownership in the district declined slightly over the study period.

D: Residents who cycle for short trips report shorter average travel times than they did before taking up cycling.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: The claim is about WHERE THE NEW CYCLISTS CAME FROM. A gives the breakdown by prior mode and corroborates it with stable pedestrian counts. B counts cyclists without identifying their previous mode. C is consistent with the claim but does not establish the substitution. D measures travel time. TRICK: Claims about substitution between behaviors require data on what people did BEFORE, not just how many do the new behavior now.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Legal theorist Ingeborg Castaneda-Whitfield has argued that judicial deference to legislatures is warranted only when the legislature has demonstrably deliberated on the constitutional question at issue; where a statute passed without any such deliberation, she holds, courts owe it no special presumption of validity and should assess it independently.

Which of the following judicial approaches, if adopted, would most clearly exemplify the position Castaneda-Whitfield advocates?

A: A court upholds a statute on the ground that legislatures are democratically accountable and courts should therefore defer to legislative judgments as a general matter.

B: A court strikes down a statute on the ground that legislative deliberation, however extensive, cannot substitute for judicial interpretation of the constitution.

C: A court examines the legislative record, finds that the constitutional objection was raised and debated at length before passage, and accordingly applies a presumption of validity -- while noting that it would have reviewed the statute independently had the record shown no such debate.

D: A court defers to the legislature because the statute addresses a technical subject on which legislators had access to expert testimony unavailable to the court.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Her position is CONDITIONAL: deference depends on demonstrated deliberation. C applies the condition, finds it met, defers, and states what it would do if unmet -- capturing both branches of the rule. A defers unconditionally. B refuses deference unconditionally. D defers for expertise, a different rationale. TRICK: Conditional claims are exemplified by an approach that tests the condition, not one that reaches the same outcome for other reasons.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Ecologist Ferdinand Oyelaran-Bergstrom has proposed that a lake's transition from clear to turbid water is not a gradual response to increasing nutrient input but a threshold effect: below a critical nutrient concentration the lake remains clear, and above it the lake shifts abruptly to a turbid state that persists even if nutrients are subsequently reduced.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Oyelaran-Bergstrom's proposal?

A: Water clarity in the lake declined steadily as nutrient input rose over a twenty-year period.

B: Lakes with higher nutrient concentrations are, on average, more turbid than lakes with lower concentrations.

C: Reducing nutrient input to the lake produced a measurable improvement in water clarity within a single season.

D: Water clarity changed little as nutrients rose from 20 to 55 micrograms per liter, collapsed within one season as concentrations passed 60, and remained turbid for eight years thereafter even after nutrient levels were returned to 35.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The proposal has TWO distinctive features: an abrupt threshold and persistence after reversal (hysteresis). D shows both -- little change below 60, collapse at the threshold, and turbidity persisting at 35, a level that was previously clear. A describes a gradual response, contradicting the threshold claim. C contradicts the persistence claim. B is a cross-lake correlation. TRICK: Threshold claims need evidence of a sharp break AND, where asserted, failure to reverse.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The Glasshouse at Verrin is a 1998 novel by Ptolemy Achterberg-Nwosu. The narrator presents the character Sabine as someone whose apparent modesty operates as a more effective form of self-display than open boasting would: _____

Which quotation from The Glasshouse at Verrin most effectively illustrates the claim?

A: "Sabine never spoke of her own work, and those who wished to know of it were obliged to ask her students, who spoke of little else."

B: "Asked about the commission, Sabine said only that the cathedral had made a poor choice and she expected to disappoint them -- a remark that travelled the length of the province within a fortnight and brought three further commissions before the first was begun."

C: "Sabine dressed plainly, kept a modest house, and was known to give away more than she kept."

D: "Her rival Estienne complained that Sabine's humility was a performance, and that everyone but Sabine could see it."

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: The claim requires modesty FUNCTIONING as self-display -- the self-deprecation must produce the advantage. B shows the modest remark spreading and generating commissions: the mechanism is visible. A shows reticence and indirect reputation but not modesty producing the effect. C shows genuine plain living. D is a rival's accusation, not a demonstration. TRICK: When a claim says a trait 'operates as' something else, the quotation must show the trait producing that outcome.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Historian of science Wilhelmina Kirchgassner-Diallo has argued that scientific instruments neither passively record a preexisting nature nor simply construct their findings out of theoretical expectation; rather, instruments constrain what can be observed in ways that shape findings while still permitting nature to resist the investigator's assumptions.

Which of the following accounts of a historical episode, if accurate, would most clearly exemplify the view Kirchgassner-Diallo advocates?

A: An astronomer's telescope, whose optics introduced a systematic distortion, initially produced measurements that seemed to confirm her theory; the same distortion also generated an anomaly she could not explain away, and pursuing it forced her to abandon the theory the instrument had appeared to support.

B: An astronomer's measurements agreed with her predictions, and later investigators confirmed that her instrument had been free of significant distortion.

C: An astronomer interpreted every reading from her telescope as confirming her theory, and historians have since shown that the readings were equally consistent with three competing theories.

D: An astronomer discarded readings that conflicted with her theory on the ground that the instrument must have malfunctioned, and her published results accordingly matched her expectations exactly.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Kirchgassner-Diallo rejects BOTH pure recording AND pure construction. A shows the instrument shaping results (distortion) yet nature pushing back (an anomaly that overturned the theory) -- both halves. B illustrates the passive-recording view she rejects. C and D illustrate the constructivist view she rejects. TRICK: When a claim rejects two extremes and stakes out a middle position, the answer must contain evidence of both forces at once.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Immunologist Ruslan Beaumont-Ikeda has proposed that early childhood exposure to a diverse microbial environment reduces the later incidence of allergic disease, and that the effect depends on exposure occurring before the immune system's regulatory pathways mature at roughly two years of age.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Beaumont-Ikeda's proposal?

A: Children raised on farms show lower rates of allergic disease than children raised in urban apartments.

B: Adults who move to rural environments show a modest reduction in allergy symptoms after several years of residence.

C: Among children with comparable genetic risk, those exposed to high microbial diversity before age two had markedly lower allergy rates in adolescence, whereas those whose first such exposure came after age three showed rates indistinguishable from children never exposed.

D: Laboratory mice raised in sterile conditions develop exaggerated immune responses to common allergens.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: The proposal has TWO parts: exposure reduces allergy AND timing before age two is essential. C tests both by comparing early exposure, late exposure, and none, with genetic risk held constant. A supports part one only, with confounding. B concerns adults, contradicting the timing claim if anything. D is an animal model addressing neither the human timing window. TRICK: When a claim specifies a critical window, the evidence must compare inside the window against outside it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Literary scholar Aurelio Tsvetkova-Mbeki has argued that in certain modernist novels the unreliability of the narrator is signalled not by contradictions in the narrator's account but by the reactions of minor characters, whose responses make sense only if what the narrator reports is false.

Which of the following, if present in such a novel, would most clearly exemplify the technique Tsvetkova-Mbeki describes?

A: The narrator states early in the novel that he has never been reliable in matters of memory, and later chapters bear out this admission.

B: The narrator's account of a dinner party contradicts, in several particulars, his account of the same evening given two chapters later.

C: A minor character tells the narrator directly that his version of events is mistaken, and the narrator concedes the point.

D: The narrator reports that his sister greeted his announcement with delight; the passage then describes the sister leaving the room, the cook declining to meet the narrator's eye, and a neighbour arriving the next morning to ask, gently, whether anyone was looking after him.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: The technique requires unreliability signalled ONLY through others' behaviour, with no internal contradiction and no explicit correction. D gives a reported reaction contradicted by what everyone else does, leaving the reader to infer the truth. B is internal contradiction, which the claim explicitly excludes. C is direct correction, not inference from behaviour. A is self-declared unreliability. TRICK: When a claim rules out a method ('not by contradictions'), eliminate any option using that method, however unreliable the narrator appears.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Claim-Example Match

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Climate economist Seraphina Oduya-Lindqvist has argued that the economic damage from extreme heat falls disproportionately on lower-income regions not because those regions experience more extreme heat, but because a given increase in temperature reduces economic output far more where work is concentrated outdoors and cooling is scarce.

Which finding, if true, would most directly support Oduya-Lindqvist's argument?

A: Lower-income regions recorded more days above 35 degrees Celsius than higher-income regions over the study period.

B: Across regions experiencing statistically indistinguishable numbers of days above 35 degrees Celsius, each additional such day reduced economic output roughly six times as much in regions where outdoor employment exceeded 40 percent and air conditioning access fell below 15 percent as in regions where those figures were reversed.

C: Total economic losses from extreme heat were larger in lower-income regions than in higher-income regions over the study period.

D: Higher-income regions have expanded air conditioning access more rapidly than lower-income regions over the past two decades.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Oduya-Lindqvist attributes the disparity to VULNERABILITY, not exposure. B holds heat exposure constant and shows the damage per hot day differing by outdoor work and cooling access -- isolating vulnerability. A supports the exposure explanation she rejects. C shows the disparity without identifying its source. D describes a trend in cooling access without linking it to output losses. TRICK: When a claim says 'not because of X but because of Y,' the strongest evidence holds X constant and varies Y.

END QUESTION